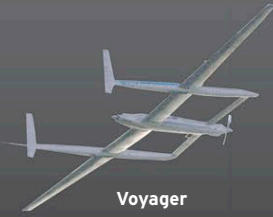




VariEze



Voyager



Proteus



SpaceShipOne

- 1943** Elbert "Burt" Rutan is born.
- 1965** Rutan graduates from Cal-Poly and works for the USAF as a civilian flight test project engineer.
- 1972** The Model 27 VariViggen flies.
- 1974** Rutan Aircraft Factory (RAF) is formed at Mojave Airport.
- 1975** The prototype Model 31 VariEze flies for the first time.
- 1976** The Vari Eze debuts at Oshkosh.
- 1978** Rutan's first twin-engine aircraft, the Model 40 Defiant, flies.

- 1979** Rutan is commissioned by NASA to complete the design work on the innovative AD-1 jet-powered, pivoting-wing research aircraft.
- 1983** The Rutan Aircraft Factory is reorganized as Scaled Composites.
- 1985** The Beech Aircraft Corporation acquires Scaled. An 85 percent scale proof-of-concept aircraft for the Beech Starship series is built and flies.
- 1987** Voyager flies around the world nonstop and nonrefueled.

- 1993** In conjunction with Bell Helicopter, Scaled builds an unmanned aerial vehicle demonstrator. A tilt-rotor, it is called Eagle Eye.
- 1996** A proof-of-concept aircraft for the Vantage personal jet is flown by Scaled at Mojave.
- 1998** Proteus, a tandem-wing aircraft used for research, is launched.
- 2002** WhiteKnightOne, the carrier vehicle for SpaceShipOne, is successfully tested.
- 2003** SpaceShipOne exceeds Mach 1.

- 2004** SpaceShipOne flies into space twice within 14 days; it wins the Ansari X prize.
- 2005** Adventurer Steve Fossett flies GlobalFlyer solo around the world.
- 2008** SpaceShipTwo's carrier vehicle, WhiteKnightTwo, flies. It is named VMS Eve after Sir Richard Branson's mother.
- 2010** The first SpaceShipTwo, the VSS Enterprise begins flight testing. Scaled announces that Rutan will retire in 2011.
- 2011** The Bi-Pod, a hybrid flying car designed by Rutan, is revealed by Scaled.

"Testing leads to failure, and failure leads to understanding."

BURT RUTAN

demonstrator called Eagle Eye for Bell Helicopter. About this time, Scaled was also involved in the emerging idea of the "personal jet," working on the design and construction of the Model 247, a POC machine for a proposed personal jet called Vantage.

In April 2003, Rutan's organization built a two-aircraft composite vehicle in an attempt to win the Ansari X prize, a \$10 million award for the first private manned space flight. Scaled designed and built both the spaceship and the carrier vehicle, and on its first powered flight, on December 17, 2003, SpaceShipOne reached 68,000 ft (20,000 m) and 930 mph (1,500 km/h), becoming the first privately funded manned aircraft to accomplish supersonic flight. The following year, two successful high-altitude SpaceShipOne flights were completed within the mandated 14-day period, winning the X prize. In July 2005, Sir Richard Branson joined forces with Scaled Composites, with the aim of producing a series of commercial suborbital spacecraft and launch vehicles. The Spaceship Company unveiled a mock-up of SpaceShipTwo at the 2012 Farnborough Air Show.

Since Burt Rutan reacquired Scaled Composites from Beech's parent company, Raytheon, in 1988, the

company has been owned or part-owned by a number of different organizations. One of these companies, Northrop Grumman, had a 40 percent stake and, in August 2007, it acquired total ownership. However, Scaled continues to operate as a separate entity and is deeply involved in futuristic aircraft, such as the X-47. This is an Unmanned Combat Air Vehicle (UCAV) demonstrator for the Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency. This striking aircraft is constructed almost entirely from composite materials, and is configured as a flying wing without vertical surfaces. It is controlled by elevons (a combination of the conventional elevators and ailerons) and flaps mounted above and below the wing.

Burt Rutan retired in 2011, but his legacy lives on in the innovative aircraft he designed. Scaled Composites continues to grow, and its future looks bright. When you can design and build a privately funded spaceship, the sky is no longer the limit.

Taking to the skies

Two of Scaled Composites's signature aircraft—the Defiant (top) and the Boomerang—fly above the Mojave Desert, California.

